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HTML block and inline elements 60m

There are two main types of HTML elements: block and inline elements.

Block-level elements

Block-level elements are blocks of content like text within a document, such as paragraphs, lists, navigation menus, footers and so on. They always start on a new line, and browsers will add margins before and after each block-level element.

A block-level element always takes up the entire available width of its parent element (container), while the height is based on the amount of its content (that is, it may take up one or multiple lines depending on its content), thereby creating a block.

`<div>` is a commonly used block element, used to define a section in an HTML document. We used them in an earlier task to loosely describe the sections of an HTML page. A `<div>` element is used as a container to group various HTML elements as a way to define that section.



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HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<div>

  <h2>This is a heading within the
div element</h2>

  <p>This is the text (or paragraph)
within the div element.</p>

</div>
```

This is a heading within the div element

This is the text (or paragraph) within the div element.

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Example 5.8 Heading within the div element



Inline elements

Inline elements are contained within block-level elements and are small pieces of content, such as text or media. These don't cause a new line to appear after the content and only take up as much width as necessary. Examples of inline elements would be text-styling elements, such as strong `<strong></strong>` or a hyperlink `<a>.</a>`

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`<span>` is a commonly used inline element, used to mark up part of a text or document. You can use a `<span>` tag as a container to group sections of a text so you can apply a style to it or manipulate it using JavaScript.



HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<div>
  <h2>This is a heading in a div
element</h2>
  <p>This is some <span
style="color:blue">text</span> in a
div element.</p>
</div>
```

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Example 5.9 Span



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Dig deeper

If you want to learn more about block and inline elements, visit [HTML Block and Inline Elements \(W3Schools, n.d.\)](#).^{fnref:a50412} This page contains a list of commonly used block and inline elements, as well as explanations and examples for each.

Attributes

We've previously discussed attributes and explained that they are used to provide additional information to an element to control how they work.



If you need a refresher about this, we recommend taking a look at the following pages:

[HTML semantic elements](#) →

Both block and inline elements support attributes, including **itemscope**, **itemtype** and **itemprop** attributes.

It is important for you to understand **itemscope**, **itemtype** and **itemprop** attributes and how they are used, as they are needed to create your portfolio web application. You will struggle to create your portfolio if you do not understand these attributes. We've included a list of self-directed learning resources if you need further information on these attributes.

What are itemscope, itemtype and itemprop attributes?

Itemscope, itemtype and itemprop are global attributes, meaning they can be used on all HTML elements.

itemscope

When the itemscope is specified, it creates a new item (a set of name-value pairs) associated with the element.

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Imagine you have a website about the *Lord of the Rings* books. You may have a page for each book, which contains information about the book, its author and genre. Your HTML code might look like this:



HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<div>
  <h1>The Lord of the Rings: The
Fellowship of the Ring. </h1>
  <span>Author: J.R.R. Tolkien (born
January 3, 1892)</span>
  <span>Fantasy fiction</span>
</div>
```

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Example 5.10 itemscope 1

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To identify the section about the particular *Lord of the Rings* book, you add an `itemscope` element. This specifies that this block is about a particular item, which in this case is a book.



HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<div itemscope >
  <h1>The Lord of the Rings: The
Fellowship of the Ring. </h1>
  <span>Author: J.R.R. Tolkien (born
January 3, 1892)</span>
  <span>Fantasy fiction</span>
</div>
```

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Example 5.11 itemscope 2

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itemtype

Related to `itemscope` is the `itemtype` attribute. This attribute specifies the URL of the vocabulary that will be used to define the item properties. Schema.org is an example of a URL used to define an item's properties.

Schema.org was created by Google, Microsoft, Yahoo and Yandex to codify how data is represented. The schema provided cover schema for products, business addresses, entertainment and many other data types.

So, we have specified that the HTML is about a particular item, but we haven't yet specified what kind of item it is. Here is where you'd use the `itemtype` attribute to specify that the content contained in the `<div>` block is about a book.



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Example 5.12 itemtype



itemprop

The `itemprop` attribute is used to add properties to an item. `Itemprop` is used to add additional information to an item, which can help search engines understand your code.

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The properties you associate with your item must be specified and match what is displayed on schema.org. So, for our example, the properties we can use can be found at schema.org/Book.



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Example 5.13 Itemprop



Now a search engine will understand the name, author and genre of the book we've listed on our web page.

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Dig deeper

MDN Web Docs by Mozilla developers explains each attribute and provides examples of each attribute used in HTML code, as well as what the web page looks like. Read the pages below:

- `itemprop`
- `itemscope`
- `itemtype`.

Schema.org also explains how to use `itemscope`, `itemtype` and `itemprop` to ensure search engines understand what is being discussed on web pages.

Read the document *Getting Started With Schema.org Using Microdata* and focus on *Section 1: How to Mark Up Your Content Using Microdata*.



Marking up web content with microdata and schema.org

Non-Assessed

Questions: **4**

You are tasked with marking up a webpage about the popular movie *Inception*. The page includes information such as the director's name, the genre and a link to the movie trailer. Choose the correct code snippet for each question.

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Done

Attempts remaining: **Unlimited**

Start

Previous attempts ▼



☒ Coding an event page

Non-Assessed

Status: Done

Reset ↺

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You are marking up an HTML page for an upcoming event called 'Tech Innovations 2026' featuring a detailed description and the event's date and time. Select the correct code snippets for each question

Find the correct code to complete each requirement.

Define the item type for the event 'Tech Innovations 2026'	<pre><div itemscope itemtype="https://schema.org/Event"></pre> ✓
Include a start date and time using the appropriate format	<pre><time itemprop="startDate" datetime="2026-04-15T09:00">April 15th, 9:00 AM</time></pre> ✓
Provide a brief description of the event using the appropriate property	<pre><div itemprop="description">Explore the latest in tech innovations!</div></pre> ✓

❌ `<span itemprop="info">Explore the latest in tech innovations!</span>`

❌ `<div itemscope itemtype="schema/Event">`

❌

`<time itemprop="eventDate" datetime="2026/04/15 09:00">April 15th, 9:00 AM</time>`

1. Define the item type for the event 'Tech Innovations 2026'.

■ `<div itemscope itemtype="https://schema.org/Event">`

■ Correct! Using `itemtype="https://schema.org/Event"` is the right approach for marking an item as an event, ensuring clear

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communication to search engines.

2. Include a start date and time using the appropriate format.

- `<time itemprop="startDate" datetime="2026-04-15T09:00">April 15th, 9:00 AM</time>`
- Correct! The startDate property with datetime in YYYY-MM-DDTHH:MM format clearly indicates the event's start date and time.

3. Provide a brief description of the event using the appropriate property.

- `<div itemprop="description">Explore the latest in tech innovations!</div>`
- Correct! The description property is correctly used to provide a brief overview of the event, allowing search engines to understand its context.

Previous attempts ▼



Next we'll look at styling within HTML.



Thoughts on this page?

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